

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

SCAN (19:34 ET)

September 17, 2026 | 07:39 PM ET

15 setups identified | 3 A-Grade | 5 B-Grade | 7 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (3)	B - Strong Setup (5)	C - Watch List (7)
PBLS	SDGR	GLOO
TRVG	CRD-B	RGR
MGNI	IMMR	LUXE
	RUSHB	SECZ
	CTKB	LVWR
		ASAN
		VICR

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	PBLS	Parabilis Medici	Biotech Innovatio	\$40.88	+10.8%	\$5.0B	82M	+56.0	97%	Breaking out near 52W
A	TRVG	trivago N.V.	Travel Recovery	\$6.69	+19.7%	\$0.5B	10M	+41.7	98%	Explosive breakout on
A	MGNI	Magnite, Inc.	Digital Advertisi	\$25.63	+7.8%	\$3.7B	142M	+41.1	96%	Breaking out on 3.4x v
B	SDGR	Schrodinger, Inc	AI Drug Discovery	\$30.24	+26.4%	\$2.3B	57M	+89.8	99%	Explosive +26% move on
B	CRD-B	Crawford & Compa	Insurance Service	\$13.10	+16.0%	\$0.6B	23M	+24.5	96%	Massive 40x volume spi
B	IMMR	Immersion Corpor	Haptic Technology	\$7.52	+5.6%	\$0.2B	28M	+11.7	93%	Breaking out on 3.5x v
B	RUSHB	Rush Enterprises	Commercial Vehicl	\$57.00	+5.8%	\$6.7B	103M	+16.7	99%	Breakout to new 52W hi
B	CTKB	Cytek Bioscience	Life Science Tool	\$5.21	+5.7%	\$0.7B	103M	+36.1	84%	Breaking out on 2.5x v
C	GLOO	Gloo Holdings, I	Software - Faith	\$4.91	+20.6%	\$0.5B	31M	+2.6	49%	Explosive +20% move on
C	RGR	Sturm, Ruger & C	Firearms / Defens	\$40.14	+8.2%	\$0.6B	14M	-1.7	83%	
C	LUXE	LuxExperience B.	Luxury Consumer	\$9.48	+7.6%	\$1.3B	18M	+17.7	83%	
C	SECZ	Securitize Corp.	Blockchain / Toke	\$8.93	+14.9%	\$1.5B	9M	-29.5	65%	
C	LVWR	LiveWire Group,	EV / Electric Mot	\$1.42	+19.3%	\$0.3B	14M	+23.5	22%	
C	ASAN	Asana, Inc.	Collaboration Sof	\$10.09	+4.6%	\$2.3B	91M	+43.7	65%	
C	VICR	Vicor Corporatio	Power Components	\$216.39	+17.7%	\$10.0B	26M	-36.8	57%	

PBLS

Parabilis Medicines, Inc.

\$40.88

+10.85%

RS vs SPY: +56.0%

A BREAKOUT

\$5.0B Cap | 82M Float

Biotechnology | Theme: Biotech Innovation | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 2.41 | Vol: 2.44x | RS/SPY: +56.0% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 56D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$40.88
Day Change	+10.85%
Mkt Cap	\$5.05B
Float	82M sh
RS vs SPY	+56.0%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	2.41
Vol vs Avg	2.44x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breaking out near 52W high on strong RS momentum; upcoming Nov 12 earnings (56d) is the forward catalyst to extend this run, with potential clinical pipeline updates. Cluster of 6 insider buys totaling \$6.9M in last 60d signals exceptional internal conviction ahead of that print.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Parabilis Medicines is a clinical-stage biotech developing novel therapeutics, likely in immunology or oncology given the insider conviction clustering. The \$6.9M in recent insider buying (6 separate transactions) is rare and suggests material upcoming catalysts beyond routine operations.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare innovation / biotech sector strength. Biotech is emerging from a multi-year bear market; names with strong RS and insider support are repricing higher as risk appetite returns to the sector. Clinical data readouts or partnership announcements could be imminent given the insider activity.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$40.88 on vol >2.4x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
The insider cluster (7 rating, 6 buys, \$6.9M in 60d) is the dominant signal here-among the strongest in this scan. This is rare, material open-market buying that typically precedes a value-accretive event. Float is large at 82M, suggesting institutional capacity; the setup has room for significant fund accumulation.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 56D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print Nov 12 (56d). No consensus data provided, but the insider buying suggests management expects a favorable setup into that event-either top/bottom-line beats or clinical/regulatory progress to be disclosed.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$37.50 (approximate base support ~92% of 52W high), or on any negative clinical trial readout or dilutive financing announcement ahead of the Nov 12 print.
ANALYSIS
RS line at new high, prox_52w 96.8%, tight base (2.41), and the insider cluster of \$6.9M is the single strongest conviction signal in this scan. Disconfirming: base_tight is marginal vs. textbook VCP (<2.0), and we're in a mixed macro regime that typically dampens follow-through. However, the insider activity upgrades this from B to A (per GRADE UPGRADE RULE). Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$40.88 on vol >2.4x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.44x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$6.69
Day Change	+19.68%
Mkt Cap	\$0.47B
Float	10M sh
RS vs SPY	+41.7%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	2.37
Vol vs Avg	7.34x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Explosive breakout on 7.3x volume at 98.4% of 52W high; technical momentum alone (RS line new high, strong 3M RS +43.9%) is driving this. Forward catalyst is Nov 3 earnings (47d), where a beat and raise in travel demand/bookings metrics would extend the move. Communications sector leadership (+1.5% vs SPY) provides tailwind.
BUSINESS & POSITION
trivago is a hotel and accommodation search platform, aggregating listings for travelers globally. The business benefits from secular travel recovery post-pandemic and monetizes via referral fees from OTAs. Small float (9.5M) creates high volatility and squeeze potential on positive news.
FACTOR & THEME
Consumer recovery / travel normalization. Global travel spend continues to recover, with corporate and leisure demand converging toward pre-pandemic levels. trivago captures incremental search volume as consumer confidence in discretionary spend improves. Sector rotation into Communications (leading this week) adds momentum.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$6.69 on vol >7.3x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume at 7.3x average suggests institutional participation, though the tiny float (9.5M) means funds can move this quickly on modest position-building. No insider buying, but the RS line at new high and sector leadership confirm smart money is rotating in. Short interest dynamics unknown but low float creates squeeze risk.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 47D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print Nov 3 (47d). Travel platforms have been serial beaters as demand inflected; trivago's small size means it's leveraged to macro travel trends but lacks the buffer of diversified OTAs. Consensus data not provided; monitor for sequential booking growth and margin expansion.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$6.00 (prior resistance / round number), or if Nov 3 earnings show decelerating bookings growth or margin compression from elevated marketing spend.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade criteria met: vol >7x, prox_52w 98.4%, rs_line_new_high, rs_vs_spy +41.7, base_tight 2.37. Communications sector leadership adds +0.5 grade bias. Disconfirming: no news catalyst today means this is purely technical, and the mixed macro regime reduces follow-through probability. Small float cuts both ways-squeeze potential vs. illiquidity risk. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$6.69 on vol >7.3x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 7.34x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$25.63
Day Change	+7.78%
Mkt Cap	\$3.68B
Float	142M sh
RS vs SPY	+41.1%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	2.25
Vol vs Avg	3.44x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breaking out on 3.4x volume with RS line at new high and prox_52w 95.5%; technical setup is pristine. Forward catalyst is Nov 4 earnings (48d), where a beat driven by programmatic ad spend growth (CTV, retail media) would confirm the re-rating. Communications sector leading this week provides macro tailwind.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Magnite is the largest independent sell-side advertising platform (SSP), helping publishers monetize inventory via programmatic auctions. The company is levered to CTV (connected TV) ad spend growth, which is taking share from linear TV, and benefits from the ongoing shift of budgets to automated, data-driven buying.
FACTOR & THEME
Digital advertising resurgence / CTV adoption. Programmatic ad spend is accelerating as brands shift budgets to addressable, measurable channels. Magnite's CTV business (via SpringServe acquisition) positions it at the intersection of streaming growth and ad-supported models (Netflix, Disney+). Sector rotation into Communications amplifies the setup.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$25.63 on vol >3.4x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 3.4x average with RS line at new high signals accumulation; the large float (141.6M) means this move requires real institutional buying, not retail chasing. No insider buying in the last 60d, but the technical structure (tight base, sector leadership, RS confirmation) suggests funds are rotating into ad-tech ahead of Nov 4 earnings.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 48D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print Nov 4 (48d). Ad-tech names have been volatile but Magnite has shown operational leverage when spend recovers. Key metrics: CTV revenue growth, take rates, and Q4 guidance (peak ad season). Serial beater status unknown but the sector has been re-rating on improving macro (ad budgets recovering from 2024-25 slowdown).
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$23.80 (approximate 50-day MA / prior resistance), or if Nov 4 earnings show decelerating CTV growth or Q4 guidance below Street due to ad budget cuts.
ANALYSIS
Five A-grade criteria: vol 3.4x, prox_52w 95.5%, rs_line_new_high, rs_vs_spy +41.1, base_tight 2.25. Communications sector leadership (+1.5% vs SPY) adds conviction. Disconfirming: no same-day catalyst identified, and the mixed macro regime means ad budgets could reverse quickly on macro weakness. Large float is favorable (institutional capacity) but also means this needs sustained buying. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$25.63 on vol >3.4x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 3.44x



SDGR

Schrodinger, Inc.

\$30.24

+26.37%

RS vs SPY: +89.8%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.3B Cap | 57M Float

Health Information Services | Theme: AI Drug Discovery | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 8.05 | Vol: 7.22x | RS/SPY: +89.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 48D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$30.24
Day Change	+26.37%
Mkt Cap	\$2.26B
Float	57M sh
RS vs SPY	+89.8%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	8.05
Vol vs Avg	7.22x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Explosive +26% move on 7.2x volume, RS line at new high, prox_52w 99.4%-this is a momentum ignition event. Likely driven by AI-pharma partnership news or clinical progress (check wires). Forward catalyst is Nov 4 earnings (48d), where software license growth and pipeline updates (drug candidates advancing) would sustain momentum.
Business & Position
Schrodinger provides computational chemistry software and services for drug discovery, leveraging physics-based simulation and AI/ML to accelerate molecule design. The company also has a proprietary pipeline of drug candidates. It sits at the intersection of AI and pharma, benefiting from the AI infrastructure wave and biopharma R&D spend.
Factor & Theme
AI infrastructure / computational drug discovery. Schrodinger is a direct play on AI adoption in life sciences-pharma companies are racing to deploy AI for faster, cheaper R&D. The company's dual model (software + proprietary pipeline) provides upside optionality. Tech sector leadership (+2.7% vs SPY) amplifies the AI theme momentum.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$30.24 on vol >7.2x of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume 7.2x average with a +26% spike suggests news-driven institutional buying-likely a partnership, clinical milestone, or major customer win. RS +89.8 vs SPY (top decile in this scan) confirms this is a leadership name. No insider buying in last 60d, but the technical breakout and sector alignment suggest funds are chasing the AI-pharma convergence theme.
Earnings
Earnings in 48D
Earnings Context
Next print Nov 4 (48d). Schrodinger is pre-profit (software revenue + milestone payments from partnerships). Key metrics: software ARR growth, new pharma partnerships, and pipeline progress (IND filings, Phase 1/2 readouts). The stock re-rates on partnership announcements and clinical milestones, not traditional earnings beats.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a close below \$27.00 (prior breakout pivot), or on any partnership termination, clinical trial failure, or weaker-than-expected software bookings at the Nov 4 print. Base_tight 8.05 is wide, indicating this is a momentum chase, not a controlled coil-expect high volatility.
Analysis
RS line at new high, prox_52w 99.4%, vol 7.2x, RS +89.8 (elite)-but base_tight 8.05 is far too wide for an A-grade (needs <2.0 for textbook coil). This is a momentum explosion, not a controlled breakout from a tight base. The +26% move likely already discounts today's catalyst; without knowing the specific news, it's unclear if there's durable fuel ahead or if this is a one-day pop. Downgrade to B despite strong RS and Tech sector tailwind. Conviction: Low.
Signal: Close above \$30.24 on vol >7.2x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 7.22x



CRD-B

Crawford & Company

\$13.10

+16.03%

RS vs SPY: +24.5%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.6B Cap | 23M Float

Insurance Brokers | Theme: Insurance Services | 52W Hi: 96% | Base Tight: 2.96 | Vol: 39.95x | RS/SPY: +24.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 46D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$13.10
Day Change	+16.03%
Mkt Cap	\$0.62B
Float	23M sh
RS vs SPY	+24.5%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	2.96
Vol vs Avg	39.95x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Massive 40x volume spike and +16% gain with RS line at new high-likely news-driven (M&A rumor, contract win, or analyst upgrade; check wires). Forward catalyst is Nov 2 earnings (46d), where claims volume trends and margin improvement would extend the move. Small float (22.6M) amplifies volatility.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Crawford is a third-party claims administrator (TPA) and loss adjusting service provider for insurance carriers and self-insured entities. The business is levered to catastrophe events (hurricanes, wildfires) and insurance industry outsourcing trends. Microcap with illiquid float makes it a niche play.
FACTOR & THEME
Insurance sector recovery / CAT event activity. Recent hurricane or wildfire activity would drive elevated claims volume, boosting Crawford's fee-based revenue. The company benefits from carriers outsourcing non-core claims handling to control costs. Financials sector is not among leaders this week, which is a headwind.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$13.10 on vol >39.9x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume 40x average is the highest in this scan-this is either a material news event (M&A offer, major contract) or a low-float squeeze. No insider buying, and the tiny market cap (\$620M) limits institutional interest to niche value/event funds. The extreme volume suggests a one-day event rather than sustained accumulation.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 46D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print Nov 2 (46d). Crawford is a low-growth, cyclical service business; earnings volatility is tied to CAT event frequency and severity. Consensus data not provided, but the stock typically trades at low multiples given limited growth prospects. A beat driven by elevated claims activity would be transient unless paired with margin expansion or M&A.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close below \$11.50 (prior resistance / 20-day MA), or if the news catalyst today is fully discounted and no follow-through material emerges. The 40x volume spike suggests today's move already incorporates the catalyst; Nov 2 earnings unlikely to add incremental fuel unless a transformative event (acquisition, restructuring) is announced.
ANALYSIS
RS line at new high, prox_52w 96.4%, vol 40x (extreme)-but base_tight 2.96 is marginal, and the 40x volume spike suggests a one-day event catalyst likely already discounted. RS +24.5 is solid but not elite. Without knowing the specific news, it's unclear if there's durable follow-through or if this is a gap-and-fade setup. Financials sector not leading dampens conviction. Downgrade from A to B. Conviction: Low.
Signal: Close above \$13.10 on vol >39.9x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 39.95x



IMMR

Immersion Corporation

\$7.52

+5.62%

RS vs SPY: +11.7%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.2B Cap | 28M Float

Software - Application | Theme: Haptic Technology | 52W Hi: 93% | Base Tight: 2.85 | Vol: 3.54x | RS/SPY: +11.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 89D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$7.52
Day Change	+5.62%
Mkt Cap	\$0.25B
Float	28M sh
RS vs SPY	+11.7%
52W Hi Prox	93%
Base Tight	2.85
Vol vs Avg	3.54x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER Breaking out on 3.5x volume near 52W high (93.4%), prox to resistance. Likely driven by VR/AR theme momentum or IP licensing deal. Forward catalyst is Dec 15 earnings (89d)-too distant to be the primary driver. Nearer-term, watch for partnership announcements or product launches in gaming/VR verticals.
BUSINESS & POSITION Immersion develops and licenses haptic (touch feedback) technology for gaming, automotive, mobile, and VR/AR applications. Revenue is IP-driven (royalties and licensing), making it lumpy and event-dependent. The company benefits from adoption of immersive interfaces but lacks the scale of platform partners.
FACTOR & THEME VR/AR adoption / gaming innovation. Haptics are a key enabler of immersive experiences in VR headsets, game controllers, and automotive HMI. Theme momentum is decelerating (VR hype peaked 2023-24), but niche IP plays can still re-rate on licensing wins. Tech sector leadership (+2.7%) provides modest tailwind.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL Close above \$7.52 on vol >3.5x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL Volume 3.5x average is solid but not extreme; RS line NOT at new high (disqualifies A-grade). The microcap size (\$250M) and IP-licensing model limit institutional interest to specialty tech funds. No insider buying. This is a speculative, event-driven setup rather than a core institutional accumulation.
EARNINGS EARNINGS IN 89D
EARNINGS CONTEXT Next print Dec 15 (89d)-too far out to be a near-term catalyst. Immersion's earnings are volatile, tied to quarterly licensing deals and legal settlements. No consensus data provided. The stock re-rates on new IP agreements or litigation wins, not operating leverage.
KEY RISK Thesis invalid on a close below \$7.00 (round number / prior support), or on lack of follow-through news (partnership, licensing deal) in the next 2-3 weeks. Dec 15 earnings too distant to sustain momentum without interim catalysts.
ANALYSIS Prox_52w 93.4%, vol 3.5x, base_tight 2.85 are solid-but rs_line_new_high is false (downgrades from A). RS +11.7 is modest. Tech sector leadership adds conviction, but the lack of a near-term catalyst (Dec 15 earnings 89d away) and RS line not confirming leadership makes this a secondary setup. Conviction: Low.
Signal: Close above \$7.52 on vol >3.5x of 20d avg Vol vs Avg: 3.54x



RUSHB

Rush Enterprises, Inc.

\$57.00

+5.75%

RS vs SPY: +16.7%

B STRONG SETUP

\$6.7B Cap | 103M Float

Auto & Truck Dealerships | Theme: Commercial Vehicles | 52W Hi: 99% | Base Tight: 3.98 | Vol: 5.0x | RS/SPY: +16.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 41D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$57.00
Day Change	+5.75%
Mkt Cap	\$6.65B
Float	103M sh
RS vs SPY	+16.7%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	3.98
Vol vs Avg	5.0x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver Breakout to new 52W high on 5x volume with RS line at new high; likely driven by strong commercial truck demand or dealer margin expansion. Forward catalyst is Oct 28 earnings (41d), where robust Class 8 truck sales and parts/service revenue would confirm the cycle upturn.
Business & Position Rush Enterprises is the largest network of commercial vehicle dealerships in North America, selling Peterbilt and International trucks plus aftermarket parts and service. Revenue is tied to freight activity, fleet replacement cycles, and regulatory mandates (emissions standards). The business is cyclical but generates steady service/parts income.
Factor & Theme Freight cycle recovery / reshoring logistics. Commercial truck demand is tied to freight volumes, which track industrial production and e-commerce. Reshoring and domestic manufacturing build-out (CHIPS Act, IRA) drive incremental fleet investment. However, freight markets are mixed in 2026-monitor freight recession risks.
Breakout Signal Close above \$57.00 on vol >5.0x of 20d avg
Institutional Volume 5x average with RS line at new high suggests accumulation; the large float (102.8M) and \$6.65B market cap mean this requires institutional buying. No insider buying in last 60d. Cyclical industrials are not in favor (Industrials not a leading sector this week), which caps conviction despite the technical breakout.
Earnings Earnings in 41D
Earnings Context Next print Oct 28 (41d). Rush typically beats on strong truck delivery and parts revenue; key metrics are Class 8 unit sales, parts/service margins, and backlog trends. The company is a cyclical earnings compounder when freight markets are healthy. Monitor for fleet order commentary and 2027 guidance.
Key Risk Thesis invalid on a close below \$54.00 (prior breakout pivot / round number), or if Oct 28 earnings show weakening truck orders, margin compression, or negative freight cycle commentary.
Analysis RS line at new high, prox_52w 99.3%, vol 5x-but base_tight 3.98 is wide (needs <2.0 for A-grade), and RS +16.7 is modest. The Oct 28 earnings (41d) is a durable forward catalyst, but cyclical exposure to freight (a mixed sector) and lack of sector leadership (Industrials not in favor) reduce conviction. Solid B-grade, not A. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$57.00 on vol >5.0x of 20d avg Vol vs Avg: 5.0x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$5.21
Day Change	+5.68%
Mkt Cap	\$0.68B
Float	103M sh
RS vs SPY	+36.1%
52W Hi Prox	84%
Base Tight	2.95
Vol vs Avg	2.5x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Breaking out on 2.5x volume with RS +36.1 and prox_52w 84.3%-nearing but not at breakout zone (>85). Likely driven by flow cytometry instrument demand or biopharma R&D spend recovery. Forward catalyst is Nov 4 earnings (48d), where installed base growth and consumables attach would confirm the thesis.
Business & Position
Cytek develops and sells advanced flow cytometry systems (full-spectrum and mass cytometry) for research and clinical applications. The company benefits from biopharma R&D investment and academic lab spending. Revenue is recurring (instruments + reagents/consumables), but growth is tied to funding cycles.
Factor & Theme
Life science tools / biopharma R&D recovery. After a 2024-25 slowdown (post-COVID funding cliff), lab equipment demand is stabilizing as NIH budgets and pharma R&D normalize. Cytek's full-spectrum technology is differentiated but faces competition from legacy players (Becton Dickinson, Thermo Fisher). Healthcare not a leading sector this week.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$5.21 on vol >2.5x of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume 2.5x average is elevated but not extreme; RS line NOT at new high (disqualifies A-grade). Large float (102.9M) means this needs sustained fund buying to work. No insider buying in last 60d. The stock is emerging from a base but lacks the technical confirmation (RS line new high, prox_52w >85) for institutional conviction.
Earnings
Earnings in 48D
Earnings Context
Next print Nov 4 (48d). Cytek's growth model is instrument placements (lumpy, upfront revenue) plus recurring consumables (higher margin). Key metrics: system placements, consumables revenue growth, and gross margin trends. Monitor for commentary on biopharma vs. academic customer mix.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a close below \$4.80 (approximate 20-day MA / base support), or if Nov 4 earnings show decelerating instrument placements or weaker consumables pull-through.
Analysis
RS +36.1, prox_52w 84.3%, vol 2.5x, base_tight 2.95-solid but not elite. RS line NOT at new high is the key downgrade factor. Prox_52w 84.3% is just below the A-grade threshold (>85). Healthcare not leading this week reduces conviction. Nov 4 earnings is a durable catalyst but the setup hasn't fully confirmed yet. Conviction: Low.
Signal: Close above \$5.21 on vol >2.5x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.5x

